



Footprints without feet (Prashant Kirad)

English A: Language and Literature SL (Rishikesh Public School)



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CLASS 10 NOTES

ENGLISH

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A TRIUMPH OF SURGERY



Learning from "A Triumph of Surgery":

The story of Tricki, the chubby dog, teaches us a lesson about being too indulgent or overly caring. Tricki's owner, Mrs. Pumphrey, loved him so much that she fed him too much, making him sick and lazy. This is like when parents give too many treats or let their kids do whatever they want.

Too Much Love Can Harm:

Tricki had a fancy life at home, but it made him unhealthy. The story suggests that too much pampering can have bad effects on health, both for pets like Tricki and for kids.

The Vet Helps Tricki Get Better:

Doctor Herriot, the vet, steps in to help Tricki. He suggests a plan to make Tricki live a more natural and balanced life. This shows that sometimes, a little tough love and setting boundaries can be good for our loved ones.

Lessons for Parents:

The story hints at the challenges of parenting. Like Tricki's owner, parents need to find a balance. Being too lenient can lead to problems. It's a reminder to think about how much freedom and treats we give to our kids.

Choosing a Balanced Lifestyle:

When Tricki is in the hospital, he has to work a bit for his food and play more. This helps him get healthier. It's like saying that a natural and balanced lifestyle is good for everyone, including our pets and kids. In simple terms, "A Triumph of Surgery" isn't just about a dog getting better; it's a reminder not to spoil our loved ones too much. Finding a balance in how we care for our pets and kids is the key to their well-being.

Extract-Based Questions.

1. Mrs. Pumphrey, anxious about Tricki's recovery, called daily for updates. Assured of Tricki's safety, she began delivering two dozen eggs to boost his strength. As recovery progressed, bottles of wine arrived, believed to enrich Tricki's blood. The household then embraced a ceremonial lunch with glasses of wine, realizing the unexpected turn of events in Tricki's unconventional recovery.

Q/A:

1. How did Mrs. Pumphrey react to Tricki's recovery, and what actions did she take?

Answer: Mrs. Pumphrey, relieved by Tricki's convalescence, brought around two dozen fresh eggs to boost his strength and later sent bottles of wine to enrich his blood.

2. What did the word 'convalescing' do to Mrs. Pumphrey, and how did it influence her actions?

Answer: The word 'convalescing' reassured Mrs. Pumphrey, prompting her to bring more eggs, believing they would aid Tricki's recovery.

3. How did the arrival of bottles of wine impact the household, and what was the intended purpose behind selling them for Tricki? them for Tricki?

Answer: The arrival of wine turned lunch into a ceremonial occasion, as Mrs. Pumphrey believed it would enrich Tricki's blood, though the veterinary partners ended up consuming it.

2. "At the surgery, the household dogs surged around me. Tricki looked down at the noisy pack with dull eyes and, when put down, lay motionless on the carpet. The other dogs, after sniffing around him for a few seconds, decided he was an uninteresting object and ignored him. I made up a bed for him in a warm loose box next to the one where the other dogs slept. For two days I kept an eye on him, giving him no food but plenty of water. At the end of the second day, he started to show some interest in his surroundings, and on the third he began to whimper when he heard the dogs in the yard."

1. How did the other dogs react to Tricki at the surgery?

Answer: They ignored him as uninteresting.

2. Where was Tricki's bed set up, and how was he cared for initially?

Answer: Bed in a warm box, given water but no food.

3. When did Tricki show improvement, and how was it evident?

Answer: Started showing interest on the third day, whimpering.

TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. What makes you know that Mrs. Pumphrey was a rich lady?

Answer: Mrs. Pumphrey was a wealthy lady as she had many servants and maids and also had a pet. She used to feed her pet with a lot of dishes, sweets, and snacks. Moreover, she had a separate room and wardrobe for her pet. All these things show that she was a rich lady.

2. Why were the household dogs not interested in Tricki initially?

Answer: Tricki was a newcomer in the house. Moreover, Tricki was very lethargic to play with them. He was not comfortable there. But after a few days, Tricki started enjoying them. He discovered the joys of being bowled over, tramped on, and squashed every few minutes. He became an accepted member of the gang.

3. Why was Dr. Herriot confident that Tricki will be in hospital soon?

Answer: Tricki was tottering (moving in an unsteady way) slowly in the house. He was not eating anything, not even his favorite dishes and besides, he had bouts of vomiting. Dr. Herriot was sure that if his food was not cut down and more exercise was not given to him, he would be really ill soon.

4. Why did Mrs. Pumphrey treats Tricki in a special way?

Answer: Mrs. Pumphrey was an extremely rich lady but was foolishly indulgent in pampering her dog, Tricki. She served him with cream cakes, chocolates, and cod liver oil. She did so because she treated Tricki like her son.

5. The household dogs at the surgery rejected Tricki as "uninteresting objects." Why?

Answer: At the surgery the household dogs surrounded Tricki. He looked at them with dull eyes. The other dogs sniffed him but he did not give any response. So they found him as an uninteresting object and rejected him.

6. How did the gang of the household dogs accept Tricki as their member?

Answer: After two or three days Tricki mixed up with the household dogs. He had a lot of fun and exercise there. He ran about with the dogs. He enjoyed being bowled over, tramped on, and squashed. Thus they accepted him as their member.

7. What special diet did Mrs. Pumphrey give to build Tricki up?

Answer: Mrs. Pumphrey found that Tricki had become listless. He seemed to have no energy. She thought he must be suffering from malnutrition. She decided to give a little special diet between meals to build him up. She gave him some malt, cod liver oil, and a bowl of Horlicks at night. She couldn't refuse cakes and chocolates to Tricki even after being advised to cut down on the sweet things.

8. What was the only fault of Tricki as diagnosed by Dr. Herriot?

Answer: Dr. Herriot knew that overindulgence and pampering of Tricki's mistress, Mrs. Pumphrey created problems for him. The only fault of Tricki was his greed for food. He had never known to refuse food. Overfeeding and not giving him proper exercise made him hugely fat and dull.

9. What excuses did Mrs. Pumphrey give for not following Dr. Herriot's advice? What was the effect of ignorance?

Answer: Dr. Herriot knew that the only fault of Tricki was his greed for food. Mrs. Pumphrey was an indulgent mistress and pampered Tricki with malt, cod-liver oil and bowls of Horlicks. Dr. Herriot had advised her to cut down on sweets and give him some exercise. Tricki was to be kept on a very strict diet. Mrs. Pumphrey told the doctor that it was very difficult. The result of ignoring the doctor's advice was disastrous. Tricki lost his appetite and lay motionless on the carpet. He vomited again and again.

10. "He had never been known to refuse food; he would tackle a meal at any hour of the day or night." Herriot believed that Tricki's problem was his greed. Did he lack tolerance? What values would you like Tricki to imbibe? Elucidate.

Answer: Dr. Herriot was not entirely wrong in believing that Tricki's problem was greed. Tricki was indeed greedy, but Mrs. Pumphrey only made matters worse by stuffing him with rich food. Herriot did not lack intolerance; he was just stating the obvious. Tricki's ill health made him concerned, and he observed a veterinary doctor. Tricki, on the other hand, needed to exercise control over his eating habits. It would have been good if he did not greedily gobble up everything that was placed in front of him. Mrs. Pumphrey herself reveals that Tricki loved cream cakes and chocolates very much. Thus, Tricki ought to have been less gluttonous (excessively greedy) and luxury-loving, and behaved more like a dog!





THE THIEF'S STORY



Anil and Hari:

Anil, a 25-year-old writer, was living a carefree life, struggling to make money through writing. One day, while watching wrestling, he met Hari, who used his old tricks to impress Anil. Anil was impressed and promised to teach Hari how to write, do math, and cook.

Learning Together:

Anil and Hari started living together happily. Anil, true to his promise, was helping Hari learn new skills. They became good friends, and life seemed good for both.

The Temptation:

One day, Hari saw a bunch of money Anil had and decided to steal it. That night, after dinner, Anil slept peacefully, unaware of Hari's plan. Hari took the money and left for the railway station to catch a train. But he missed it, and it started raining.

A Change of Heart:

Wet and conflicted, Hari felt guilty about betraying Anil's trust. Instead of leaving, he decided to return the money. Hari came back, placed the money where he found it, and battled his guilt through the rainy night.

A Fresh Start:

The next morning, Anil woke up late, and Hari had already made tea. Anil, without showing any anger, gave Hari Rs. 50 as a reward for his efforts, signaling a fresh start. Even though the money was wet, Anil seemed to understand Hari's change of heart.

The Lesson Learned:

In the end, "The Thief's Story" teaches us about the importance of trust and friendship. Anil forgave Hari, and Hari learned that values like trust and compassion are more important than any stolen money. It's a story about second chances and the goodness that can come from doing the right thing.

Extract-Based Questions.

1 He took me to his room over the Jumna Sweet Shop and told me I could sleep on the balcony. But the meal I cooked that night must have been terrible because Anil gave it to a stray dog and told me to be soft but I just hung around, smiling in my most appealing way, and he couldn't help laughing.

1. What does 'I' refer to?

Ans. I' refers to Hari Singh.

2. Where did Mil take him?

Ans. Anil took him to the room where he stayed, over Jumna sweet shop.

3. How did Anil react when Hari cooked a bad meal?

Ans. Anil gave the food to the stray dogs and asked Hari to leave.

2 " hurried back to the room feeling very nervous, for it is much easier to steal something than to return undetected".

1. Who is the speaker of this line?

Ans. Hari, a young boy is the speaker of this line who is a thief

2. Why was the speaker feeling nervous?

Ans. Because he was keeping back the stolen money and feared getting caught.

3. Why was it difficult for the speaker to return the money?

Ans. He feared getting caught while keeping it back.

 TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)**1. Why did Hari Singh decide to come back to Anil?**

Answer: Hari Singh decided to come back to Anil because he felt that when Anil came to know about the theft, he would feel sad, not for the loss of money but for the loss of trust. He did not want to lose his trust.

2. Why was it difficult for Hari Singh to rob Anil?

Answer: It was difficult to rob Anil because he was the most trusting person Hari Singh had ever met. According to Hari Singh, it's easy to rob a greedy man because he can afford to be robbed but it's difficult to rob a careless man because he doesn't even notice that he's been robbed and that takes all the pleasure out of the work.

3. What are the different reactions of the people when they are robbed?

Answer: According to Hari Singh, different people react differently upon being robbed. The greedy man displays fear, the rich man shows anger, and the poor man shows acceptance. However, a trusting man like Anil would be sad due to the loss of trust.

4. Why did the thief smile without any effort towards the end of the story?

Answer: The thief was under tension that his master would be angry with him for stealing the money. But Anil did not express any anger. He said that he would pay him regularly and would remain to continue teaching him full sentences. This made him tension free and he smiled without any effort.

5. Why did Hari Singh think of doing some real work?

Answer: By 'real work' Hari Singh means stealing. He wants to steal Anil's money because he has not stolen anything for a long time. Secondly, Anil is a careless man. If Hari Singh did not steal his money, he would waste it on useless things.

6. How and when did Hari Singh meet Anil?

Answer: Hari Singh met Anil during a wrestling match. He found Anil easy going, kind and simple enough to suit his purpose. Anil's trusting nature could help him with stealing. Therefore, he offered himself to work for Anil. Anil had no regular income and couldn't afford to pay him. But still Hari Singh exploited Anil's generosity and he forced Anil to keep him in his house.

7. Why was it so difficult for Hari Singh to rob a trusting and unsuspecting person like Anil?

Answer: The fifteen-year-old thief, Hari Singh was an experienced and fairly successful hand. It was easy to rob a greedy man because he could afford to be robbed. But it was very difficult to rob a careless and unsuspecting man like Anil. The unsuspecting Anil didn't even notice that he had been robbed. That could take all the pleasure out of the work of theft.

8. How did Hari Singh steal the money that Anil got from selling his book to a publisher?

Answer: Hari Singh saw with his own eyes how Anil tucked the bundle of money under the mattress of his bed. When Anil was asleep, Hari Singh crept up to the bed. He slid his hand under the mattress and drew the money out of the bundle without making a sound. Anil sighed in his sleep and turned on his side, towards him. Hari Singh got startled and quickly came out of the room.

9. Anil plays a major role in the transformation of Hari Singh. Comment on the statement by highlighting the values possessed by Anil which touched Hari's heart and made him return to his honest ways of earning his livelihood. Write in about 100-120 words.

Answer: Anil was a struggling writer who befriended Hari Singh. Hari Singh was an experienced, 15-year-old thief. He found Anil an easy target to steal. Anil offered him to stay with him and to teach how to read and write. Gradually, Anil develops trust in Hari Singh. But Hari Singh was waiting for the right opportunity to do what he was best at.

After stealing money, he tried to go away forever but some inner voice stopped him from doing so. He returned to Anil because he wanted to live a life of respect. Anil did not show that he knew the incident and accepted Hari with open hands. Thus, a well-intentioned person, Anil changed Had Singh and brought him on the right path. The story shows that trust and spirit to forgive someone can bring big changes in someone's life.

10. Hari Singh didn't confess that he robbed Anil. Did he lack the courage to do so or he really wanted to maintain his relationship with Anil at any cost? Explain the values Had needed to imbibe in about 100-120 words.

Answer: Hari Singh was a teenager, of 15. He was good at stealing. He chose Anil to be his next target as he was a struggling author and a simple person. Had Singh started living with Anil who in turn, started teaching him how to read and write? Hari Singh, one day got the opportunity to steal Anil's money. He left with the money to go away forever but his inner "ice" stopped him. He returned and kept the money in place. The next morning he started with his routine work and didn't say anything about the incident to Anil. He was a teenager and lacked the courage to face Anil with his truth. He did not want to lose Anil's trust. He wanted to maintain the relationship with Anil, wanted to get an education, and become a respected man. So, he hid the incident from Anil.





THE MIDNIGHT VISITOR



Introduction:

Robert Arthur's "The Midnight Visitor" unfolds a gripping detective story featuring the cunning secret agent Ausable. The narrative revolves around a high-stakes encounter with Max, Ausable's rival, and the ingenious strategies Ausable employs to outsmart his adversary.

Ausable's Mission:

Ausable, the detective, anticipates retrieving sensitive papers in his hotel room. However, Max, his rival, ambushes him at gunpoint, demanding the coveted documents.

Ausable's Remarkable Response:

Despite the threat, Ausable exhibits remarkable composure. He weaves a fictional tale about a non-existent balcony, befuddling Max and creating a diversion.

Fowler's Bewilderment:

Fowler, Ausable's friend, is astonished to discover the unexpected identity of the seemingly unfit secret agent. The suspense builds as Max holds them at gunpoint.

The Inventive Balcony Ruse:

Ausable, sensing danger, invents a fictional balcony below the window, convincing Max that the police are at the door. Max, fearing arrest, leaps to his demise, unaware of the nonexistent balcony.

Adventurous Evening Turns Lethal:

What begins as a planned evening for Fowler transforms into an unexpected and perilous encounter with a secret agent, leading to a life-or-death situation.

The Wine Delivery Twist:

As Max awaits on the imaginary balcony, a waiter arrives with a wine delivery. Ausable reveals the absence of police and the non-existence of the balcony, leaving Fowler bewildered.

Ausable's Quick Wit Triumphs:

Ausable's quick thinking and clever storytelling prove triumphant. Max's nervousness and panic lead to his fatal decision, as he jumps from the hotel's top floor.

Conclusion:

"The Midnight Visitor" delivers a compelling message about maintaining composure in challenging situations. Ausable's wit and resourcefulness showcase the power of quick thinking and adaptability, ultimately saving him from a perilous encounter.

Extract-Based Questions.

Q1: And then there was his accent. Though he spoke French and German passably, he had never altogether lost the American accent he had brought to Paris from Boston twenty years ago.

(a) Who is 'he' in the above extract?

Ans: 'He' in the above extract is Ausable, a secret agent.

(b) Where is he at present?

Ans: At present, he is about to enter his room on the sixth floor of a French hotel.

(c) Find the word from the extract that means the opposite of 'fluently'

Ans: The word is 'passably'.

(d) What is the present tense of 'speak'?

Ans: 'Speak' is its present tense.

Q2: "You are disillusioned", Ausable told him. "But take cheer, my young friend. Presently you will see a paper, a quite important paper for which several men and women have risked their lives, come to me. Some day soon that paper may well affect the course of history. In that thought is drama, is there not?" [CBSE2015]

(a) Who is 'my young friend' in the above extract?

Ans: 'My young friend' in the above extract is Fowler, a young romantic writer.

(b) What is the 'important paper' referred to here?

Ans: The 'important paper' referred to here is a report regarding some new missiles.

(c) Find a word from the passage that means the same as 'disappointed'

Ans: The word is 'disillusioned':

TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. How did Max go out of Ausable's room to save himself from the police?

Answer: Max was very nervous to find the police at the door. He went out of the window saying that he would wait in the balcony. He warned Ausable to send them away or he would shoot him. Max did not confirm the balcony and stepped out of the window and died.

2. How did Ausable kill Max without using a weapon?

Answer: Ausable was an intelligent spy. When he found Max waiting for him in his room, he made a story of a balcony under his window. He convinced Max about the balcony. Thus, when someone knocked at the door, Max fearing it to be the police, jumped out of the window and died.

3. How did Ausable kill Max without using a weapon?

Answer: Ausable was an intelligent spy. When he found Max waiting for him in his room, he made a story of a balcony under his window. He convinced Max about the balcony. Thus, when someone knocked at the door, Max fearing it to be the police, jumped out of the window and died.

4. Why was Ausable confident that Max would never return?

Answer: Believing Ausable's story about the balcony to be true, Max stepped out, however, had concocted a very convincing story, and knew that what awaited him was a drop from the sixth floor. Hence, he was confident that Max would never return.

5. Did Max really deserve to get a chance to accomplish a risky task?

Answer: I do not believe that Max deserved a chance to accomplish a risky task, as he is very smart, gun. A spy without these nor very intelligent. He did not even look threatening to Fowler except seeing apparent qualities will most likely be a failure.

6. How did Ausable befool Max about the balcony?

Answer: Ausable was a very intelligent spy agent. When he found Max waiting for him in his room, he immediately thought of the plan. He told Max that there is a balcony from where people enter his room and Max must have also entered from there. Max was convinced about the story and hence when someone knocked at the door, he ran towards the balcony to hide and died.

7. What was the real story of the balcony below the window of Ausable's room?

Answer: Ausable had an instant and fertile mind. He could cook up all kinds of stories that fit in different situations. Actually, there was no balcony below the window of his room. Ausable cooked up a story that the balcony below his room had become a big nuisance. It was the second time that someone had got into his room through it. Actually, he wanted to confuse Max and make him jump out of the window to get rid of him.

8. What position did Max take before he jumped out of the window?

Answer: Max kept his body twisted. In this way, he could keep his gun pointed at Ausable and Fowler. He grasped the frame with his free hand to support himself. He swung his other leg up and over the windowsill. The moment he heard the knocking getting louder at the door, he positioned himself to jump out of the window.

9. Ausable was a successful secret agent. What qualities can be attributed to him? Give some examples.

Answer: Ausable was very fat. He appeared to be a slow and sluggish person. But inside that fat body, he had a very sharp brain.

It was throwing his presence of mind, intelligence and cleverness that he got rid of Max easily. When Max heard a knock at the door Ausable told in a hat was the police whom he had called for the extra protection of the papers.

Max wanted him to send them off quickly until he waited on the balcony. Ausable had ordered a drink and it was the waiter with the drink knocking at the door. Ausable used the false story to mislead Max. The poor fellow was neither police nor law. He jumped through the window, not one on the balcony but on the ground from the sixth floor. Max lost his life and with him died that he was his mission a clever secret agent. Way Ausable got rid of Max. They may assemble got rid of Max proves that he was a clever secret agent.

10. Write a character sketch of the secret Agent Ausable.

Answer: Ausable was a secret agent. He was a fat and sloppy fellow. In his appearance, he did not seem to be a romantic figure. He came to Paris from Boston twenty years ago. He could speak French and German passably. He had not lost the American accent. Ausable was a very intelligent person. He had a great presence of mind. He did not lose heart in a difficult situation when he faced a man with a pistol in his hand. He remained cool. He cooked up a story about the balcony. He made Max nervous by telling him about the police. He got Max killed without any fighting or shooting. Fowler who was disappointed to meet him at the beginning of the story was very much impressed with his intelligence and presence of mind at the end of the story.





A QUESTION OF TRUST?

The Sneaky Book Lover:

Meet Horace Danby, a 50-year-old locksmith who seemed like a nice guy. He ran a successful business and loved buying rare books. But here's the twist — he wasn't totally honest. Once a year, he'd secretly rob a safe to fund his expensive book habit.

The Plan: Horace's Secret Scheme:

With two helpers, Horace carefully planned each heist. This time, he targeted Shotover Grange, a house he'd been watching for two weeks. When the family went to London and the caretakers went to the movies, Horace saw his chance.

The Surprise:

As he was doing his thing, a young lady showed up, pretending to be the owner's wife. She claimed she needed her jewels for a party. Caught off guard, Horace opened the safe for her, forgetting his gloves and leaving behind a big clue.

The Trouble Begins:

A few days later, a policeman arrested Horace for the jewel robbery. His fingerprints were all over the crime scene. He admitted to opening the safe for the fake wife, but no one believed him.

The Big Reveal:

Turns out, the young lady was a fraud. The story ends with Horace, once a successful guy, now in prison, realizing that blindly trusting others can lead to big trouble.

Conclusion:

In simple terms, the story teaches us not to trust people without really knowing them. Horace Danby's mistake was believing someone without checking if they were telling the truth. So, be careful who you trust — not everyone is as honest as they seem!

Extract-Based Questions.

Q1. So he robbed a safe every year. Each year he planned carefully just what he would do, stole enough to last for twelve months, and secretly bought the books he loved through an agent.

(a) Who is 'he' in the above extract?

Ans: 'He' in the above extract is Horace Danby.

(b) Why did 'he' rob only one safe every year?

Ans: He robbed only one safe every year because he robbed just enough to satisfy his hobby of buying and collecting rare and expensive books. Otherwise, he was just an honest lock-maker.

(c) Find the word from the extract that means the opposite of 'openly':

Ans: The word is 'secretly'.

Q2. A small dog was lying in the kitchen. It stirred, made a noise, and moved its tail in a friendly way (CBSE 2014)

(a) What is the dog's name mentioned in the above extract?

Ans: The name of the dog mentioned in the above extract is Sherry.

(b) In which house is the kitchen referred to?

Ans: The kitchen referred to is located in Shotover Grange.

(c) Find a word from the passage that means the same as 'cordial'.

Ans: The word is 'friendly'.

TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. Though Horace planned everything meticulously, why did he fail?

Answer: Though Horace planned everything meticulously; he failed to lead because of the smart lady. She posed herself to be the owner of the house and convinced him to open the shelf as she did "not the password of the shelf. Horace got trapped in her plot.

2. Who is the real culprit in this story, the lady or Horace? How did he/she manage to rob the safe without leaving a single fingerprint?

Answer: In this story, the real culprit is the young lady. She managed to trick Horace into breaking the safe for her. She did not even touch the safe herself. She managed to get all the jewels. She had to do no physical exercise for this. In this way, she managed to rob the safe without leaving a single fingerprint.

3. Why is Horace Danby described as good and respectable but not completely honest?

Answer: Horace Danby was a good person. He made locks. He was very successful in his business. He had engaged two helpers in his business. But he was not completely honest because he robbed a safe every year.

4. Describe how Horace Danby planned his work?

Answer: Horace Danby studied the house at Shotover Grange for two weeks. He studied its rooms, its electric wiring, its paths, and its garden. He was sure that the family was in London. The two servants had gone to the movies and they would not come back before four hours. He came out from behind the garden wall and entered the house.

5. Did Horace get the jewels from the Grange safe? If not, why did the police arrest him?

Answer: No, Horace did not get the jewels from the Grange safe. But he broke open the safe for the wife of the owner of the house without gloves. But in reality, that lady was a burglar. Thus, there were Horace's fingerprints all over the room. So, the police arrested him for stealing the jewels from the Grange safe.

6. Whose voice was it that advised Horace about the special treatment of his hay fever?

Answer: When Horace was about to open the safe, he heard a female voice. She asked if he suffered from a cold or hay fever. He was sneezing again and again. She said that he could cure the hay fever with special treatment. He must find out what plant gave him that disease. She also advised Horace to see a doctor.

7. When and why did the woman in red say, "Society must be protected from men like you"? Doesn't it sound ironical?

Answer: Horace assured the woman in red that he would not hurt her. She must forget she ever met him. It made her angry. She couldn't let him go, otherwise, he would rob someone else. Society must be protected from people like him. It sounds ironic because she herself was a thief and had come for the same purpose for which Horace was there in the house.

8. Do you think that the young woman in red proved far smarter than Horace Danby? Give reasons.

Answer: Definitely, the young woman in red proved far smarter than Horace Danby. She played her part of being the lady of the house with complete perfection. She was an example of self-confidence. She didn't show any hesitation. She spoke and acted with an air of complete confidence and authority. Poor Horace became a puppet who couldn't take himself out of her spell. She threatened to call the police and made him open the safe, while Horace was later caught and arrested. She decamped with the jewels.

9. Who is the real culprit in the story, the young lady in red or Horace Danby? Comment.

Answer: The law of any land works on evidence. Horace Danby opened the safe without wearing his gloves. He didn't think it necessary to wear them as he thought he was working for 'the lady of the house'. So the police matched his fingerprints and he was arrested. The lady in the red was the real culprit. She made Horace open the safe for her. She was also a thief and decamped with the jewels. But in the eyes of the law, Horace was the real culprit because the evidence was against him.

10. Why did Horace Danby prefer books to collect paintings?

Answer: Horace Danby loved rare books passionately. To fuel his hobby, he resorted to robbing a safe annually. When faced with a choice between collecting books and paintings, he opted for books due to limited space in his small house.



FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET

Griffin's Invisible Experiment

Once upon a time, there was a scientist named Griffin. He figured out how to become invisible and touch things. Excited about his discovery, he decided to try it out.

Becoming Invisible:

Griffin drank a special potion and became invisible. But, oh no! He accidentally stepped in mud, leaving footprints that curious folks followed until they disappeared.

Invisible Night Out:

To stay warm, Griffin went to a shopping center after it closed. He wore some clothes and ate from a café. When night fell, he made a bed out of quilts in a store.

London Adventures:

People started noticing him, so Griffin stole clothes and money. To escape, he took off all his clothes, becoming invisible again. Life in busy London became a challenge.

Moving to Iping:

Griffin decided to move to a quiet village called Iping. People there were puzzled by his strange appearance.

Invisible Troubles:

As money ran out, Griffin turned to stealing and even hurt some people. People thought there were ghosts in the village. When the constable tried to find Griffin, he tricked them by appearing headless.

Conclusion:

This story teaches us that sometimes discovering new things can be tricky. Griffin's adventure shows us that we must be careful with what we discover and use it responsibly.

Extract-Based Questions.

Q1. As they gazed, a remarkable sight met their eyes. A fresh footmark appeared from nowhere. Further footprints followed one after another, descending the steps and progressing down the street.

(a) Who are 'they' in the above extract?

Ans: 'They' in the above extract are two boys on a street in London.

(b) Who is making these footprints?

Ans: The scientist Griffin, who has become invisible, is making these footprints.

(c) Find the word from the extract that means the same as 'continuing'.

Ans: The word is 'progressing'.

(d) What is the opposite of 'remarkable'?

Ans: Its opposite is 'ordinary'.

Q2: The air was bitterly cold and he could not do without clothes. Instead of walking about the streets he decided to slip into a big London store for warmth.

(a) Who is 'he' in the above extract?

Ans: 'He' in the above extract is Griffin, the invisible scientist.

(b) Why was the air bitterly cold?

Ans: The air was bitterly cold because the season was mid-winter.

(c) Find a word from the extract that means the same as 'quietly enter'.

Ans: The word is 'slip'.

(d) What is the opposite of 'warmth'?

Ans: Its opposite is 'chill'.

TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. What did the Halls see in the scientist's room? [CBSE 2013]

Answer: As the door of the room was open and nobody appeared to be inside, the Halls entered the scientist's room. They saw that the bedclothes were cold, showing that the scientist must have been up for some time; and stranger still, the clothes and bandages that he always wore were lying about the room.

2. How did the visible man become invisible? What did he do then? [CBSE 2014]

Answer: The invisible man got angry with Mrs Hall for asking an explanation for the mysterious happenings

and threw off all he was wearing on his head so that he became a man without a head. Soon the constable Jaffers arrived to arrest him, but the invisible man threw off all his clothes to become invisible and, in the ensuing scuffle, knocked Jaffers unconscious and escaped.

3. Griffin was not a true scientist as he misused his scientific discovery. Illustrate this point by giving two incidents from the story.

Answer: A true scientist is a law-abiding person. A scientist is also called a 'natural philosopher'. Griffin was not a true scientist as he did not use his discovery of how to make himself invisible for good uses. He lost control of himself and behaved like a criminal. First, he set fire to his landlord's house and ran away. Then he stole food without paying for it in a London store. Besides, he robbed the owner of a theatrical company and stole money from a clergyman's desk.

4. Describe the landlord's and his wife's experience with the strange scientist. [CBSE 2016]

Answer: Both Mrs Hall and her husband were surprised to find the scientist's room door open because normally it was always locked. So they peeped in but found nobody there. The clothes and bandages that he always wore were lying about the room. Suddenly Mrs Hall heard a sniff close to her ear and the hat on the bedpost leapt up and dashed itself into her face. Then the bedroom chair sprang into the air and pushed them both out of the room and then appeared to slam and lock the door after them. Mrs Hall became hysterical and almost fell down the stairs. She thought that her furniture was haunted. They decided to confront the scientist next time when they met him.

5. What impression do you form of Griffin after reading the lesson, "Footprint, without Feet"?

Answer: Griffin was a brilliant scientist, as he discovered a drug due to which his body became transparent as a sheet of glass after swallowing it. This made him invisible. But he was a lawless person. Because of his misdeeds, he became a homeless wanderer without clothes and money. He was an introvert with a desire for solitude. He was always seeking adventure, and being fond of mysterious things. However, he was unscrupulous, as he robbed various people to finance his work, he got angry very quickly, which caused him to become a fugitive.

6. If, somehow you discovered how to become invisible, how would you use that opportunity? [CBSE 2015]

Answer: If I discovered how to become invisible, I would use this opportunity to punish all those people who cause trouble to others for their selfish motives. I would catch them and hand them over to the police without letting them know that I was behind them. I will also help law-enforcing agencies when they conduct raids on criminal hideouts, as I will be able to move in the open without fear of being seen. This will help the people of the country to become more law-abiding citizens.

7. 'Brilliant scientist though he was, Griffin was a lawless person. Does this statement approve the apprehension that science in wrong hands is Devil's Pandora Box?'

Answer: Griffin was a brilliant scientist. He had discovered a rare drug that could make a human body invisible. This made Griffin an arrogant lawless person. He broke the law more than once but never for a good reason. He could dedicate his discovery to his country but he didn't do that. His lawlessness made the law helpless. All his actions prove that science in devil's hand is disastrous.

8. "Scientific discoveries have made life easier but insecure." Explain with reference to the story 'Footprints without Feet' written by H.G. Wells.

Answer: There is no doubt that scientific discoveries have made life easier. Take any sphere of human activity, electricity, telecommunications, electronics, computers, etc, these have changed man's life.

We can interact and walk on the moon. A trip to Mars is next on our agenda. We can fly like birds. Supersonic planes fly at more than the speed of sound. Wonderful drugs can overcome deadly diseases. Surgery can replace defective limbs. Despite all these discoveries, human life is becoming insecure. Weapons of mass destruction are a constant danger. The fear of chemical, or biological warfare looms large. Diseases like AIDS and SARS can destroy the human race.

9. "A lawless scientist is a curse to the society." Discuss.

Answer: It is true, that a lawless scientist is a curse to society. A true scientist uses his discoveries for the good of the society and welfare of the people. It helps the nations to progress. A lawless scientist increases the misery and suffering of society. In this story, we find how Griffin misuses his discovery. He causes pain and suffering to others. He causes destruction. Suppose nuclear weapons fall in the hands of a lawless scientist, he can cause widespread destruction. He may ruin the achievements of other scientists. That's why the leaders of the world are worried about chemical weapons falling into the hands of lawless heads of governments or terrorists. If this happens, all the scientists of the world will be doomed.

10. How did the invisible man first become visible?

Answer: Griffin was completely invisible until he happened to step in some mud, which caused him to leave footprints as he walked. Two boys noticed these footprints and followed him as long as the prints were visible. Griffin, after getting rid of them, went into a big London store to put on some warm clothes. After the store was shut, he got himself dressed in an overcoat and a wide-brimmed hat. He also put on a pair of shoes. This made him visible to the people who came to work at the store the next day.





THE MAKING OF A SCIENTIST



Curious Beginnings:

This story is about Richard Ebright, a scientist who loved exploring since he was a little kid. He collected butterflies, coins, fossils, and rocks. His mom gave him a book called 'The Travel of Monarch X,' which ignited his passion for science.

Learning from Nature:

Richard realized that to achieve something special, he needed to do something extraordinary. In a science fair, he experimented with monarch caterpillars and viceroy butterflies, earning him recognition and prizes.

High School Discoveries:

In high school, Richard's experiments led to big discoveries. He found a new insect hormone and unraveled the mystery of tiny golden spots on monarch pupa. He even came up with a new theory about how cells read the blueprint of DNA.

A Big Leap:

As he continued his studies, Richard created a plastic model to explain how DNA works. This idea was a big hit and got published. He graduated from Harvard with top honors, showing that hard work pays off.

Beyond Science:

Richard wasn't just about science. He loved public speaking, debate, and outdoor activities like canoeing. He was competitive but always aimed to do his best.

Lesson Learned:

The story teaches us that if you work hard and stay dedicated, you can achieve your dreams. Richard Ebright's journey from a curious kid to a successful scientist is proof that with perseverance, anything is possible.

Extract-Based Questions.

Q1: So he did, and did he ever! Beginning in kindergarten, Ebricht collected butterflies with same determination that has marked all his activities.

(a) What does 'he did' in the extract refer to?

Ans: 'He did' refers to Richard's habit of collecting various things.

(b) What else did he collect other than butterflies?

Ans: He collected fossils, coins, and rocks other than butterflies.

(c) Find a word from the extract which means 'resoluteness'

Ans: 'Determination' is a word from the extract which means 'resoluteness'!

(d) What is the opposite of 'Beginning'?

Ans: Its opposite is 'Ending'.

Q2: He would catch a female monarch, take her eggs, and raise them in his basement through their life cycle

(a) Who is 'he' in this extract?

Ans: 'Richard Ebricht is 'he' in this extract.

(b) Why does he raise butterflies?

Ans: He raised butterflies to study their migration pattern.

(c) Find a synonym for the word 'rear' from the extract given above.

Ans: 'Raise' is the synonym of 'rear' from the extract.

(d) What part of speech is 'them'?

Ans: It is a pronoun

TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. Why did Richard lose interest in tagging butterflies?

Answer: Richard raised thousands of butterflies, tagged them and released them to study their migration. But soon, he lost interest because only two of his tagged butterflies were returned to him and they had travelled only seventy-five miles.

2. Discuss the role of Ebricht's mother in making him a scientist. [CBSE 2011]

Answer: Richard's mother played a huge role in making him a great scientist. She would take him on trips to encourage learning.

He was a single child. After his father died, his mother made him the focus of her life. She would buy him all kinds of microscopes, telescopes and other equipment. After dinner, she gave him problems to solve. This helped Richard to learn a lot. She was his only companion for a long time. It was his mother who got him the book 'The Travels of Monarch X'. This book opened the world of science for Richard. She also wrote to Dr Urquhart to guide her son. The scientist helped Richard and guided him. Thus, his mother shaped him into an extraordinary scientist.

3. Ebright's study of monarch pupas had a far reaching impact. Elaborate.

Answer: For a long time the scientific community had regarded the bright spots on a monarch pupa as purely ornamental. But Dr Urquhart did not believe it. Nor did Richard. He started his experiments on the monarch pupa. He built a device with the help of a friend. This led to the discovery of a hormone. Richard proved that the hormone was necessary for the growth of the butterfly. This discovery got him many honors. Also, it led to another important study. He began working on how cells read their DNA. DNA is the carrier of heredity and is called the blueprint of life. His theory could find answers to many cancers and diseases.

4. Richard Ebright displayed a well-rounded personality. Do you agree? Elucidate in the context of the given text. [CBSE 2016]

Answer: Richard's genius was obvious by the time he was in second grade. He managed to collect all twenty-five species of butterflies around his hometown and classify them. He also loved to collect coins, fossils, and rocks. Science was not his only passion. He was an active member of his school's oratory club and Model United Nations club and was an effective debater and a public speaker. He loved photography as well. He was an enthusiastic canoeist and an all-around outdoors person. Learning was easy for him. So he found it simple to devote time and energy to many other interests. He became a champion in whatever he did. He believed in the spirit of competition to win. But, he did not wish to defeat others just to win. He wanted to win to do his best. Thus, he displayed a well-tounded personality.

5. Dr Urquhart contributed significantly to Ebright's growth as a scientist. Explain.

Answer: Richard had become bored with collecting butterflies. His mother got him a book on the migration of butterflies. Richard came in contact with Dr Urquhart through the book. Dr Urquhart directed him to study the migration pattern of butterflies. When he did not win any prize in the science fair in seventh grade, he again wrote to Dr Urquhart to guide him. The scientist gave him many suggestions for new experiments. Richard performed these experiments throughout his high school and won many prizes. Later, he worked on why bright spots are found on a monarch pupa, motivated by Dr Urquhart. It led to the discovery of a new hormone. The discovery of this new hormone further led to an important theory. The theory was about how cells read their DNA. In this way Dr Urquhart proved to be his true mentor.

6. What are the values required to become a successful scientist like Richard Ebright? Elaborate with reference to the lesson 'The Making of a Scientist'.

Answer: Curiosity to know more and motivation to find reasons for the existence of anything or any phenomena are necessary for becoming a successful scientist. The urge to know more develops the scientific aptitude in a person. At a very young age, Ebright became competitive by participating in various county fairs. He never lost hope and kept on trying to do better. In addition to curiosity and motivation, Ebright displayed the qualities of hard work, sincerity, determination, and patience. He also accepted failure and success in the right spirit. Thus, he became a successful scientist.

7. Although Richard did not win anything at the science fair it was a stepping stone for his success. Concerning the story 'The Making of a Scientist' of the above statement, give your comments on whether competitions are for winning sake or to give your best at work.

Answer: It is true, no one can deny the fact that every person wants to be a winner. Each has a basic wish to reach 'at the top'. For that many competitions are organised at various levels. But still, we must accept that all cannot be winners. Participation is more important than winning. The participant should work hard to reach their level best.

Failures should not make us disheartened and best way to overcome failure is to learn through our mistakes. We cannot deny that experimentation and learning are stepping stones to our success. So we should try to give our best.

8. Why did viceroy butterflies copy monarchs?

Answer: Viceroy butterflies copied monarchs because monarchs do not taste good to birds. Viceroy butterflies on the other hand taste good to birds. So, the more they look similar to monarchs, the less likely they are to become a bird's prey. Thus they protect themselves.

9. Why did Richard Ebright give up tagging butterflies?

Answer: Richard Ebright lost interest in tagging butterflies as it was tedious and there was not much feedback. He could recapture only two butterflies in all the time he did it and they were not more than seventy-five miles away from where he lived..

10. How did Richard Ebright's mother help him to become a scientist?

Answer: Ebright's mother was his only companion. She used to encourage the child to learn whatever he wanted to learn. She took him on trips and brought him telescopes, microscopes, cameras, mounting materials, and other such equipment.





THE NECKLACE



Introduction:

Once upon a time, there was a lady named Mathilde Loisel and her husband. They weren't rich but lived a simple life. Mathilde, however, wanted to be rich and own fancy things like a big house, pretty dresses, and lots of jewelry.

The Party Invitation Surprise:

One day, Mathilde's husband got an invitation to a fancy party. He thought she would be happy, but she wasn't. She cried because she didn't have a nice dress for the party. Her kind husband gave her money that he had saved to buy a gun, so she could buy a pretty dress.

Borrowing Shine: The Necklace Trouble:

As the party got closer, Mathilde worried again. This time, it was about not having jewelry. Her husband suggested borrowing from their friend, Jeanne Forestier. Mathilde borrowed a beautiful necklace and enjoyed the party, making everyone notice her. But things took a turn when they lost the necklace on the way home.

Paying a High Price for Deception:

To fix the problem, they bought a new necklace, spending a lot of money they didn't have. It took them ten years of hard work and sacrifices to repay the borrowed money. Their life changed a lot during this time, moving to a smaller home and doing everything themselves.

The Shocking Truth Revealed:

Years later, Mathilde met Jeanne Forestier and confessed. However, the shock came when Jeanne revealed that the necklace was fake, and not worth much. All the struggles and sacrifices were for nothing.

Conclusion: Simple Joys Matter:

In the end, "The Necklace" teaches us not to always want more and to be happy with what we have. It warns about the consequences of pretending and the importance of being truthful. The story shows that true happiness comes from appreciating the simple things in life.

Extract-Based Questions.

1. *"she learned the odious work of a kitchen. She washed the dishes. She washed the soiled linen, their clothes and dishcloths, which she hung on the line to dry; she took down the refuse to the street each morning and brought up the water, stopping at each landing to catch her breath. And, clothed like a woman of the people, she went to the grocer's, the butcher's and the fruiterer's, with her basket on her arm, shopping, haggling to the last sou of her miserable money.*

The husband worked evenings, putting the books of some merchants in order, and nights he often did copying at five sous a page. And this life lasted for ten years. At the end of ten years, they had restored all. Mme Loisel seemed old now. She had become a strong, hard woman, the crude woman of the poor household. Her hair badly dressed, her skirts awry, her hands red, she spoke in a loud tone, and washed the floors with large pails of water."

A) Who seemed old now?

Ans. Matilda seemed old now.

B) What had made her 'crude'?

Ans. Ten long years of poverty, and a constant struggle and strife for survival had made her 'crude'.

C) Which word in the given extract is an antonym to 'pleasant'?

Ans. 'Odious' is the antonym of 'pleasant' in the extract.

2. *"He threw around her shoulders those modest wraps they had carried whose poverty clashed with the elegance of the ball costume. She wished to hurry away in order not to be noticed by the other women who were wrapping themselves in rich furs.*

Loisel detained her, "Wait," said he. "I am going to call a cab." But she would not listen and descended the steps rapidly. When they were

in the street, they found no carriage; and they began to seek for one, hailing the coachmen whom they saw at a distance. They walked along toward the river, hopeless and shivering. Finally they found one of those old carriages that one sees in Paris after nightfall."

A) What precedes these lines?

Ans. These lines follow Matilda's success at the ball where she was idolized. Her beauty and elegance was praised by everyone.

B) 'She' wished to hurry away. Why?

Ans. She, 'Matilda' did not wish to shatter the illusion of her grandeur that she had so successfully managed to convey to others by putting on such a shabby wrap. So, she wished to hurry away to escape the notice of the rich women.

C) Which word in the given extract is a synonym of 'not expensive'?

Ans. 'Modest' is the synonym of 'not expensive' from the extract.



TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. What, do you think, were the feelings of Madame Forester when she came to know that Matilda returned her a diamond necklace in place of an artificial one?

Answer: Matilda borrowed a necklace from Madame Forestier to wear at a party. She lost it somewhere and in that place returned a diamond necklace to her. She was unaware of the fact that it was an artificial one. Madame Forester was shocked to know the whole story. Madame Forestier thought that situation could have been avoided if Matilda had dared to accept the truth and share it with Madame Forester.

2. How would you feel if you were in Matilda's place and had lost somebody's such a valuable possession?

Answer: Matilda borrowed a necklace from Madame Forestier to wear in a ball. She lost it the same night. She was too upset at the incident and tried to find it everywhere in the fold of the dress, the cloak, the pockets, and. Even Mr Loisel went to search for it at midnight. They even could not sleep all night. They went to the police and even to the cab office and put an advertisement in the newspaper offering a reward. If I had been in Matilda's place, I would have done all the above-said efforts for such a valuable possession.

3. What changes occurred in Mine Loisel after 10 years?

Answer: Madame Loisel now knows the horrible life of necessity. She sent away from her maid and learned the odious work of a kitchen. She washed the dishes and the clothes on her own, She took down wastes to the street and brought up the water stopping at each landing to breathe. They changed their lodging and rented some rooms in the attic. She seemed old now and became strong and hard women. Her hair badly dressed her skirts awry, her hands red and spoke in a loud voice.

4. Why did Madame Loisel leave the ball in a hurry? What does it show about her character?

Answer: Madame Loisel left the ball in a hurry because her husband threw the modest wraps around her shoulders, whose poverty clashed with the elegance of the ball costume. She did not want to be noticed by the other women who were wrapping themselves in rich furs. It shows the hypocrisy and showoff life of Mine Loisel. It shows her dissatisfaction, anger and frustration with life.

5. How did M. Loisel and Madame Loisel manage to buy a diamond necklace to return it to Madame Forester? What were the consequences?

Answer: Mr Loisel and Madame Loisel spent all their savings i.e. eighteen thousand francs, which his father had saved for him. The rest of the money they borrowed from usurers with ruinous promises. They had to arrange 36,000 francs for the new diamond necklace. All this ruined their life. Mme Loisel had to do all odd jobs to save money. They had to change these lodgings Mr Loisel had to work till late at night after office hours, putting the books of some merchant or to copy pages at five soups a page to earn extra money.

6. What efforts did Matilda and her husband make to look for the lost necklace?

Answer: They looked into the folds of Matilda's dress, in the folds of her cloak, and in her pockets. Her husband searched the whole route by which they had come home. He returned at seven o'clock. He informed the police. He went to the newspaper's office to announce a reward. But the lost necklace was not found.

7. why did Matilda think that she was born in a family of petty clerks by some error of destiny?

Answer: Matilda was a beautiful young lady with high dreams and aspirations. She had no dowry, no hopes, no fame, and no wealth. She lost all hopes of marrying a man either rich or distinguished. She believed that she was born into a family of clerks only by some error of destiny. So, she allowed herself to marry a petty clerk in the office of the Board of Education.

8. How did Mr Loisel meet the demand for a suitable costume for his wife for going to the ball?

Answer: Matilda refused to go to the ball without having a suitable costume for the occasion. Her husband asked her to wear the dress that she wore while going to the theatre. When Matilda reacted strongly, he asked how much a suitable costume would cost. She replied that it would cost 400 francs. Mr Loisel turned pale. He had saved 400 francs to buy a gun for him to shoot larks. But he bowed down and agreed to give 400 francs to have a pretty dress.

9. Matilda realized that one little act of negligence can lead to total ruin. How would you prefer to be guided to move on in life?

Answer: Matilda lost the necklace that she borrowed from Mme Forester. She had to buy a new necklace for thirty-six thousand francs which ruined all her savings. She had changed her lodgings and did all jobs like washing, cleaning, and shopping grocery while her husband had to do extra work of copying after his office time. She lost all her beauty. Now she realized that one little act of negligence can lead to total ruin. We will prefer to move on in life according to the situation. If we have committed any mistake we have to pay for it. And we should pay for it bravely. There is no harm in doing household jobs or in earning extra money after office time. If we can live in a big house we should learn to live in a small one too with the demand of time.

10. Loisel wished to keep his wife in good humor. Which values of Matilda impress him?

Answer: Loisel really loved his beautiful wife Matilda. Even though they didn't have much money, he did everything he could to make her happy. When they got an invitation to a fancy ball, he used all his savings to buy her a new dress and replace a lost diamond necklace. Loisel even worked extra hours after his regular job to afford these things because he cared so much about his wife's happiness.





BHOLI



Early Struggles of Bholi

Once upon a time in a village, there was a girl named Bholi. She had a hard time speaking clearly because of a sickness in her brain. Also, smallpox left marks on her face, making her look different. People made fun of her, calling her Bholi, meaning backward.

Bholi's Family:

Bholi was the youngest in a family with seven kids. Her parents worried about her because she was not as healthy as her siblings. They also worried about finding a good husband for her.

A New Beginning: School Opening::

One day, an important person came to start a school in the village. He asked Bholi's father to send her to school. Bholi's mother wasn't sure but eventually agreed.

Bholi's School Days:

At first, Bholi was scared of going to school. But she got nice clothes and felt happy to be around other kids. She couldn't speak well when the teacher asked her name, and the other kids laughed. The teacher was kind and told Bholi she could improve if she came to school daily.

Bholi's Progress:

Time passed, and the village became a small town. Bholi's little school turned into a big one. Bholi not only learned to speak without stammering but also became confident and smart.

Unexpected Marriage Proposal:

One day, someone wanted to marry Bholi, but he was only interested in money. He refused to marry her without a big payment.

Bholi's Brave Decision:

Even though her family managed to gather the money, Bholi said no. She surprised everyone by speaking confidently. She refused to marry someone who cared only about money. She promised to take care of her parents and teach in the school that changed her life.

Conclusion: Bholi's Inspiring Story:

Bholi's story teaches us that with support and going to school, anyone can overcome difficulties. Bholi faced her problems and stood up for herself, becoming an inspiration for others.

Extract-Based Questions.

1 Her name was Sulekha, but since her childhood everyone had been calling her Bholi, the simpleton. She was the fourth daughter of Numberdar Ramlal. When she was ten months old, she had fallen off the cot on her head and perhaps it had damaged some part of her brain. That was why she remained a backward child and came to be known as Bholi, the simpleton. At birth, the child was very fair and pretty. But when she was two years old, she had an attack of small-pox. Only the eyes were saved, but the entire body was permanently disfigured by deep black pockmarks. Little Sulekha could not speak till she was five, and when at last she learnt to speak, she stammered. The other children often made fun of her and mimicked her. The other children often made fun of her and mimicked her. As a result, she talked very little."

A) What did Sulekha later on come to be known as?

Ans. Sulekha later on came to be known as Bholi.

B) Why did children make fun of her?

Ans. Children made fun of her because she stammered while speaking.

C) What does the word 'mimicked' mean?

Ans. The word 'mimicked' means to copy the speech of others.

2 "What's your name, little one?" "Bh-Bho-Bho-." She could stammer no further than that. Then she began to cry and tears flowed from her eyes in a helpless flood. She kept her head down as she sat in her corner, not daring to look up at the girls, who, she knew, were still laughing at her. When the school bell rang, all the girls scurried out of the classroom, but Bholi dared not leave her corner. Her head still lowered, she kept on sobbing. "Bholi." The teacher's voice was so soft and soothing! in all her life she had never been called like that. It touched her heart. "Get up," said the teacher. It was not a command, but just a friendly suggestion. Bholi got up. "Now tell me your name."

A) Who is 'she'?

Ans. 'She' is Sulekha, also known as Bholi.

B) Why were the girls laughing at her?

Ans. The girls were laughing at her because she had stammered while speaking her name when asked by the teacher.

c) What does the word 'daring' mean in the context of the extract?

Ans. The word 'daring' means lack of courage to do something.

TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. Why did Bishamber's marriage with Bholi not take place? [CBSE 2013]

Answer: Bholi rejected Bishamber's marriage proposal as he demanded a dowry of 5000 rupees. Bholi believed in love over material demands, refusing to support the outdated dowry tradition. Her father, sharing her values, declined the demand, stating his daughter's worth couldn't be measured by money. Bishamber insisted on the dowry, but Bholi stood firm. News of her refusal spread, making her a symbol of resistance against the harmful practice. Bholi's decision not only spared her from a problematic marriage but also inspired others in the village to question and challenge age-old traditions, promoting healthier relationships based on love and respect.

2. Did Bholi enjoy her first day in school? What made her happy on this very day?

Answer: It was a mixed day for Bholi. She was happy to see the girls of her age. She was fascinated with the colorful pictures on the walls of the classrooms. But when the teacher asked her name she could not answer properly and the other girls laughed at her. She cried. But her teacher's soft words made her happy on this very day.

3. How did Bholi's teacher play an important role in changing the course of her life?

Answer: Bholi's teacher played an important role in changing the course of her life. She was polite and friendly which touched her heart. She encouraged her every time and was affectionate towards her. The teacher transformed her into a confident person who could read, write and speak clearly. This gave her the required confidence. Moreover, teacher's appreciation and encouragement helped her overcome her own morale.

4. 'Dowry is negation of the girl's dignity'. Discuss with reference to the story 'Bholi'.

Answer: A girl is an individual in her own right. Equal opportunities in life can help her become independent and strong. She is not a burdensome object to be given away with money as compensation. Thus dowry negates the girl's dignity and self-respect. The story 'Bholi' dramatically shows this. Bholi is thought to be ugly and dumb by her parents. So, they are willing to pay a dowry to an old man with a limp. So that he marries her. Bholi, on the other hand, refuses to marry that man. She is educated; assertive and capable of taking care of herself. She dedicates her life to the service of her parents and teaching at school. parents. So, they are willing to pay a dowry to an old man with a limp. So that he marries her. Bholi, on the other hand, refuses to marry that man. She is educated; assertive and capable of taking care of herself. She dedicates her life to the service of her parents and teaching at school.

5. Why was Ramlal worried about Bholi and not about his other children?

Answer: All other children of Ramlal were healthy and good looking. Bholi was the only girl who was neither intelligent nor good looking. She was a simpleton, she stammered also. Ramlal was extremely worried about her future.

6. Did Bholi enjoy her first day in school? What made her happy on this very day?

Answer: It was a mixed day for Bholi. She was happy to see the girls of her age. She was fascinated with the colourful pictures on the wall of the classrooms. But when the teacher asked her name she could not answer properly and other girls laughed at her. She cried. But her teacher's soft words made her happy on this very day.

7. The chapter 'Bholi' highlights the discrimination against the girl child. Analyse.

Answer: Nature does not discriminate, but society does. From time immemorial the world has discriminated against the girl child. The chapter, 'Bholi' throws up many such instances. Randal's sons go to school and college. His daughters are not educated but married off. Her mother does not think it necessary to take Bholi's consent for her marriage. The groom is old and lame. Still, he demands dowry. Her father is ready to pay him also. It is the girl herself who raises her voice against this marriage. She is criticized and humiliated for standing up for her dignity. But she is firm and decides the course of her life.

8. Bholi is a child different from others. This difference makes her an object of neglect and laughter. Elaborate.

Answer: Society does not tolerate differences very easily. Bholi is not like others. She is slow for her age. She stammers when she speaks. Smallpox leaves her all covered with pock-marks. As a result, she has to suffer a lot. Her parents do not even bathe her. She is ignored and neglected. They take her only as a burden. People laugh at her. Children imitate her when she speaks. So, she remains silent most of the time. She has no confidence or self-esteem. Society must realize that it must accept those who are "different. They must be treated with the same love and respect as others.

9. "Bholi's whole personality underwent a complete transformation towards the end of the story". Explain.

Answer: Bholi's real name was Sulekha but she was called Bholi, the simpleton as she was a backward child. She started speaking only when she turned five but she stammered when she spoke and as a result she was always mimicked or made fun of by the other children. Therefore, Bholi talked very little.

Bholi did not know what exactly a school was and what happened there, in the class when her teacher asked her name, she stammered and began to cry. She kept her head down throughout the class. The teacher was very encouraging and friendly to her and this made her gain confidence to speak. She started seeing a ray of hope for a new life. After years of gaining education and with the help of her teacher, Bholi turned into a confident girl. She no longer stammered and could speak properly. She even had the courage to refuse marrying the lame old man because he was greedy and asked money from her father to marry her. On seeing her father worried about her marriage, she said that he need not worry as she would teach in the same school where she learnt so much and would take care of him and her mother in their old age.

10. 'Love and encouragement make the impossible possible. Explain this statement on the basis of the story 'Bholi'.

Bholi was sent to school as her mother thought her to be a burden. She was neglected by her parents as she was not beautiful and lacked intelligence. The teacher in the school asked her to tell her name. She stammered and began to cry. The teacher showed her affection and encouraged her in a friendly manner to put aside her fear. Bholi somehow told her name. Bholi was surprised. The teacher asked her to come to school regularly. The love and encouragement shown by the teacher brought out drastic changes in Bholi's personality. Within a few years, she became so confident that she refused to marry a greedy man.





THE BOOK THAT SAVED THE EARTH



Martians on Earth:

In a funny play set in the 20th century, imaginary characters with strange names like Chief Think Tank and Sergeant Oop go on a mission to Earth to learn about humans, or as they call them, "earthlings."

Library Confusion:

The Martians land in a library filled with books. Chief Think Tank, who thinks he's the smartest because of his big head, mistakes the books for sandwiches. He believes humans keep their food in these strange places.

Pills and Misunderstandings:

Trying to figure out the purpose of the books, Noodle suggests taking vitamin pills to make them smarter. Under the influence of these pills, they attempt to read a rhyme book called Mother Goose. However, their literal understanding of the rhymes leads to confusion.

Escape Plan:

As they interpret a rhyme about Humpty Dumpty, Think Tank believes Earthlings have identified him and might harm him. In a panic, the Martians decide to postpone their invasion plans. A dusty book of rhymes unintentionally prevents an invasion from happening.

Lesson Learned:

The play teaches us a lesson: having only a little knowledge can be risky. The Martians' misunderstanding of books shows that we need to be careful and understand things properly before making conclusions. It's a funny reminder that learning should be thorough and thoughtful.

Extract-Based Questions.

1. **lota:** I can't figure it out, Captain. (holding up a book) I've counted two thousand of these peculiar items.

This place must be some sort of storage barn.

A) What could lota not figure out?

Ans. lota could not figure out what the books were because he had never seen a book before.

B) Where was lota?

Ans. lota was at Centerville Public Library on Earth.

C) Find the antonym of the word 'ordinary' in the extract.

Ans. The antonym of ordinary is peculiar.

D) What part of speech is 'peculiar' as used in the extract?

Ans. It is an adjective.

2. **NOODLE:** Where shall we go, sir?

THINK-TANK: A hundred million miles away from Mars. Order the invasion fleet to evacuate the entire planet of Mars. We are heading for Alpha Centauri, a hundred million miles away. (Omega, lota, and Oop run off right as Noodle helps Think-Tank off left and the curtain closes. Spotlight shines on Historian down right.)

Historian: (chuckling) And that's how one dusty old book of nursery rhymes saved the world from a Martian invasion. As you all know, in the twenty-fifth century, five hundred years after all this happened, we Earthlings resumed contact with Mars, and we even became very friendly with the Martians. By that time, Great and Mighty Think-Tank had been replaced by a very clever Martian - the wise and wonderful Noodle! Oh, yes, we taught the Martians the difference between sandwiches and books. We taught them how to read, too, and we established a model library in their capital city of Marsopolis. But as you might expect, there is still one book that the Martians can never bring themselves to read. You've guessed it - Mother Goose! (She bows and exits right.)

A) What was the name of the book?

Ans. 'Mother Goose' was the name of the book.

B) Why did the Historian chuckle?

Ans. The historian chuckled at the idea that the misinterpretation of a book saved the Earth.

C) Which word in the extract is a synonym of 'Conquer'?

Ans. 'Invasion' from the extract is the synonym of 'conquer'.

D) What part of speech is 'And' as used in the extract?

Ans. 'And' is a conjunction

 TOP 10 PYQS (MOST EXPECTED)

1. How did a book change Think-Tank's opinion about the Earthlings? [CBSE 2014]

Answer: This book is misunderstood by the Martians.

The Martians thought that earthlings were planning to invade Mars. So, they canceled their invasion of Earth and went back. Think-Tank misunderstands the book. Phrases like 'shell', 'silver', and 'garden' gave him a false idea that earthlings grew silver and weapons. He starts thinking that earthlings are very advanced technologically.

2. What was Noodle's version to describe the so-called 'sandwich'?

Answer: Noodle hesitantly told Think-Tank that he had 'insignificant' information about those 'sandwiches'. He informed him that he had seen surveyor films of those sandwiches. He had noticed that the Earthlings did not eat them. They used them as some sort of communication devices.

3. What saved the Earth? How?

Answer: One dusty old book of nursery rhymes saved the earth from a Martian invasion. The Martian could not decipher the meaning of nursery rhymes. Their misinterpretation made the situation comical. They began to believe that the Earthlings had advance technology and were planning to invade the Mars. They called off their mission and even left the Mars isolated to escape to a far-off planet.

4. How did the book change Think-Tank's opinion about the Earthlings?

Answer: Think-Tank used to believe that the Martian was a superior race to the Earthlings. But after cracking the so-called code of an old nursery rhyme book, he changed his view about the Earthlings. He now thought that the Earthlings has reached a high level of civilization and planning to invade the Mars. It made him call off his mission.

5. Noodle hails Think-Tank as the most powerful and intelligent creature in the whole universe. Do you agree? Write your opinion of Think-Tank citing instances from the given text.

Answer: Noodle is a trainee under Think-Tank. He bows before him and hails his ruler as the most powerful and intelligent creature in the universe. However, Think-Tank is not intelligent. He misinterprets the nursery rhymes completely. 'Silver', 'shells', and 'garden' for him mean that the earthlings are growing metals on farms. He thinks books to be sandwiches and wants the crew to eat them. When he is read the nursery rhyme which says, 'Humpty-Dumpty had a great fall' he is terrified and plans his escape from Mars. Thus, Think-Tank is nothing more than a show-off and a pompous fool.

6. Why was the twentieth century called the 'Era of the Book'?

Answer: The twentieth century was often called the 'Era of the book'. In those days, there were books about everything, from anteaters to Zulus. Books taught people how to, when to, where to, and why to. They illustrated, educated, punctuated, and even decorated.

7. Where did Captain Omega reach with her team?

Answer: Captain Omega landed on the earth with her team. They found themselves in the Centerville Public Library amidst thousands of books. They thought they were in some sort of storage bam.

8. Compare and contrast the characters of Noodle and Think-Tank. [CBSE 2012]

Answer: Noodle and Think-Tank have contrasting characters. Think-Tank likes to be called the 'Great and the Mighty'. He orders and commands. He is the ruler of Mars but has no intelligence. He thinks books are sandwiches. He is wrong about everything. He demands that the crew obey him. He likes to pass on other's ideas as his own. He is a coward who simply boasts about his power.

9. The play, 'The Book That Saved the Earth' conveys the message that misunderstanding of cultural differences between various races can cause confusion and conflict. Based on your reading of the play, write how such confusion and conflicts can be checked so that peace and harmony is maintained. [CBSE 2015]

Answer: The confusion in the mind of Think-Tank occurred due to the literal interpretation of the nursery rhymes in the book Mother Goose. To ensure that conflicts are checked so that peace and harmony are maintained, cultural differences should be sorted out by initially sending mature and wise people from one culture to the other to establish contact before deciding to wage war. Think-Tank had sent an initial probe, but the crew members of the probe were not sufficiently intelligent or mature to understand Earth's culture. That is why they interpreted the nursery rhymes and caused misunderstanding in the mind of Think-Tank.

10. Rushing to a conclusion without going into details may lead to chaos and failure. Elaborate this concerning the Martian invasion in the chapter 'The Book That Saved the Earth'.

Answer: The Martians were very proud of themselves. Great and mighty Think-Thank regarded as the ruler of Mars was always caught in self-praise. He had a quick mind and wished to attack the earth in a great hurry. Martians misinterpreted the signals received from Earthling's book of nursery rhymes and fled away. If they had planned the things decisively things would have been different. In any kind of situation, rash decisions would never give results. It is only through knowledge, perseverance.

